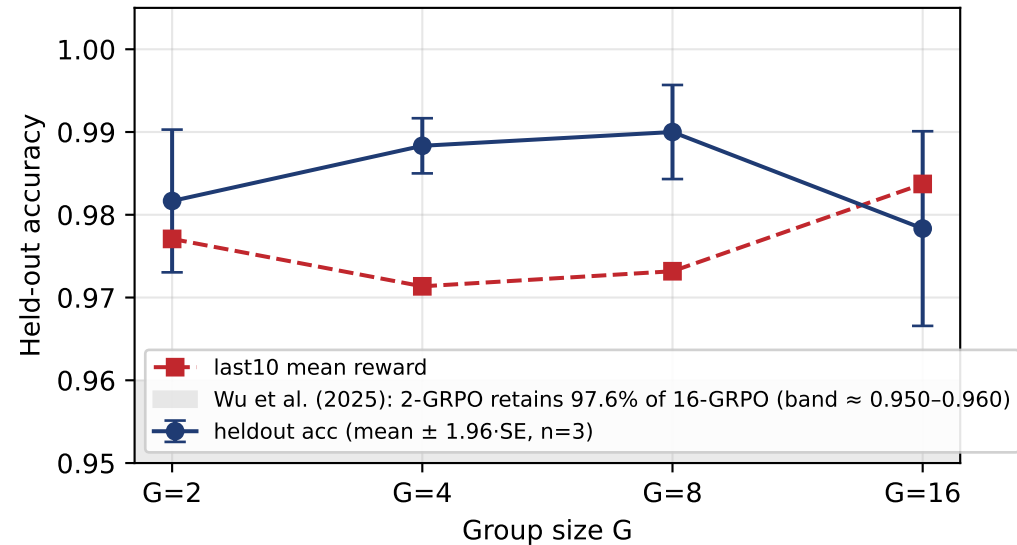


Group size G: measured inverted-U on small model + token-budget rightward shift on canonical training scale

Measured Qwen2.5-0.5B / arithmetic sweep
(3 seeds $\times$ 40 steps each)



Token-budget normalized sweep (Qwen3-8B / GSM8K)
T = 64M tokens, K = 1, illustrative reanalysis

